

Second Terminal Examination – 2079

Class : XII

Subject: C. English (0041)

Full Marks: 75

Time: 3 hrs.

SET A

Pass Marks: 30

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

We sit in the last row, bumped about but free of stares. The bus rolls out of the dull crossroads of the city, and we are soon in open countryside, with fields of sunflowers as far as the eye can see, their heads all facing us. Where there is no water, the land reverts to desert. While still on level ground we see in the distance the tall range of the Mount Bogda, abrupt like a shining prism laid horizontally on the desert surface. It is over 5,000 metres high, and the peaks are under permanent snow, in powerful contrast to the flat desert all around. Heaven Lake lies part of the way up this range, about 2,000 metres above sea-level, at the foot of one of the higher snow-peaks.

As the bus climbs, the sky, brilliant before, grows overcast. I have brought nothing warm to wear: it is all down at the hotel in Urumqi. Rain begins to fall. The man behind me is eating overpoweringly smelly goat's cheese. The bus window leaks inhospitably but reveals a beautiful view. We have passed quickly from desert through arable land to pasture, and the ground is now green with grass, the slopes dark with pine. A few cattle drink at a clear stream flowing past moss-covered stones; it is a Constable landscape. The stream changes into a white torrent, and as we climb higher I wish more and more that I had brought with me something warmer than the pair of shorts that have served me so well in the desert. The stream (which, we are told, rises in Heaven Lake) disappears and we continue our slow ascent. About noon, we arrive at Heaven Lake, and look for a place to stay at the foot, which is the resort area. We get a room in a small cottage, and I am happy to note that there are thick quilts on the beds.

Standing outside the cottage we survey our surroundings. Heaven Lake is long, sardine-shaped and fed by snowmelt from a stream at its head. The lake is an intense blue, surrounded on all sides by green mountain walls, dotted with distant sheep. At the head of the lake, beyond the delta of the inflowing stream, is a massive snow-capped peak which dominates the vista; it is part of a series of peaks that culminate, a little out of view, in Mount Bogda itself.

For those who live in the resort there is a small mess-hall by the shore. We eat here sometimes, and sometimes buy food from the vendors outside, who sell kabab and

naan until the last buses leave. The kababs, cooked on skewers over charcoal braziers, are particularly good; highly spiced and well-done. Horse's milk is available too from the local Kazakh herdsmen, but I decline this. I am so affected by the cold that Mr. Cao, the relaxed young man who runs the mess, lends me a spare pair of trousers, several sizes too large but more than comfortable. Once I am warm again, I feel a pre-dinner spurt of energy - dinner will be long in coming - and I ask him whether the lake is good for swimming in.

"Swimming?" Mr. Cao says. "You aren't thinking of swimming, are you?"

"I thought I might," I confess. "What's the water like?"

He doesn't answer me immediately, examining some receipts with exaggerated interest. Mr. Cao, with great off-handedness, addresses the air. "People are often drowned here," he says. After a pause, he continues. "When was the last one?" This question is directed at the cook, who is preparing a tray of mantou (squat white steamed bread rolls), and who now appears, wiping his doughy hand across his forehead. "Was it the Beijing athlete?" asks Mr. Cao.

A. Based on your understanding of the above passage, complete the statements given below with the help of options that follow **[5×1 = 5]**

- (a)** One benefit of sitting in the last row of the bus was that:
- (i) the narrator enjoyed the bumps.
 - (ii) no one stared at him.
 - (iii) he could see the sunflowers.
 - (iv) he avoided the dullness of the city.
- (b)** The narrator was travelling to:
- (i) Mount Bogda
 - (ii) a 2000 metre high snow peak
 - (iii) Heaven Lake
 - (iv) Urumqi
- (c)** On reaching the destination the narrator felt relieved because:
- (i) he had got away from the desert.
 - (ii) a difficult journey had come to an end.
 - (iii) he could watch the snow peak.
 - (iv) there were thick quilts on the bed.
- (d)** Mount Bogda is compared to:
- (i) a horizontal desert surface
 - (ii) a shining prism
 - (iii) a Constable landscape
 - (iv) the overcast sky
- (e)** Mr. Cao doesn't not like the narrator to swim in the lake.....
- (i) because many people are often drown there.
 - (ii) because water is warm.
 - (iii) because the narrator may get affected by cold.
 - (iv) because the narrator doesn't know swimming.

B. Answer the following questions briefly.

[5×1 = 5]

- (i) Which two things in the bus made the narrator feel uncomfortable?
- (ii) What made the scene look like a Constable landscape?
- (iii) What did he regret as the bus climbed higher?
- (iv) Why did the narrator like to buy food from outside?
- (v) What is ironic about the pair of trousers lent by Mr. Cao?

C. Find words from the passage which mean the same as the following:

[5×1 = 5]

- (i) cultivable
- (ii) climb
- (iii) gush
- (iv) sellers
- (v) increased

2. Write short answers to the following questions.

[5×2 = 10]

- (a) What did Rakesh do to make his father's old age more comfortable? (*A Devoted Son*)
- (b) Do you think the speaker wants to be the way men wanted her to be? What is the statement's significance in relation to the title of the poem? (*I Was My Own Route*)
- (c) Why is Gaston surprised by his wife's expression towards the end of the story? (*A Respectable Woman*)
- (d) Are universal human qualities equal to everyone? What do you think is the main argument of the essay, *Humility*?
- (e) What is the significance of Evan's dream with the story's plot? Discuss (*The Treasure in the Forest*)

3. Write long answers to the following questions.

[2×5 = 10]

- (a) According to Russel, 'The pursuit of knowledge may become harmful unless it is combined with wisdom.' Justify this statement with relevant examples. (*Knowledge and Wisdom*)
- (b) The protagonist, plot, and the other elements of *Facing Death* justify it as a Modern Tragedy. Discuss.

4. Some opine that digitization in the financial sector is easing the customers nowadays in Nepal. However, others feel there are some challenges in it. Write a few paragraphs on the increasing use of digitization in banking/financial sector and the challenges of the trend in Nepal. (150 Words)

[7]

5. Write a letter to the editor of a national newspaper suggesting ways to increase greenery and open spaces in the Kathmandu Valley. (180 words)

[8]

6. Write a short biography of your favorite celebrity/leader/social worker featuring the following guidelines: (300 words)

Date and place of birth

Family background

School life

Special event of his/her life, etc.

[10]

7. Do as directed and rewrite the sentences.

[10×1 = 10]

- (a) When (do) you get home? I got home yesterday. (*Fill in the blank with the suitable form.*)
- (b) If I hadn't fought with my sister, she (*wouldn't have left/ wouldn't leave*) the house.
- (c) She was extremely tired. She attended my birthday party. (*Join the sentences using 'although'.*)
- (d) The bank will sanction you the loan provided that you a collateral. (*deposit*)
- (e) He has hidden something in his mind, so he does not look fresh. (*Change the statement into if sentence.*)
- (f) The electrician said, "Don't touch the electric wires". (*Change the direct speech into reported speech.*)
- (g) He earns 40 thousand rupees a month but spends 50 thousand.
He spends..... (*Comparison involving verbs: Rewrite the sentence with the given phrase.*)
- (h) My mother gets up at 5 o' clock. (*always*) (*Put the frequency adverb in the correct place.*)
- (i) I'm longing to know what time the bank opens. (*Change the statement into indirect question.*)
- (j) She always goes to school **on foot**. (*Make a wh-question so that the words in bold become the answer.*)

8. Do as directed.

[5×1 = 5]

- (a) Make a sensible sentence with the word **debris**.
- (b) Make a compound word with **touch**.
- (c) Write two words with the suffix **-ment**.
- (d) Write the synonym of **smirk**.
- (e) *He burned the candle at both ends*. What does it mean?
 - i. he wasted a candle ii. wasted energy
 - iii. acted foolishly iv. worked very hard.